

# French A1 — Week 7 Vocabulary Reference

Crescere | Beginner French | Week 7

Theme: Shopping, Clothing, and the Market

## Demonstrative Adjectives

Demonstratives point to specific things: "this," "that," "these," "those." In French, they agree in gender and number with the noun they modify — and there is a special masculine singular form before a vowel sound.

|         | Masculine (before consonant) | Masculine (before vowel/h muet) | Feminine        | Plural            |
|---------|------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| Form    | ce                           | cet                             | cette           | ces               |
| Example | ce pantalon                  | cet imperméable                 | cette robe      | ces chaussures    |
| English | this/that trouser            | this/that raincoat              | this/that dress | these/those shoes |

**Key note:** *Ce, cet, cette, and ces* all mean both "this" and "that." French does not distinguish near vs. far with separate forms (unlike Spanish *este/ese*). Context makes the meaning clear.

**Cet before vowels:** *cet imperméable, cet homme, cet anorak*. The -t is sounded when followed by a vowel (liaison-like).

### Examples in context

| French                                   | English                          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Je voudrais <b>ce</b> pantalon noir.     | I'd like these black trousers.   |
| <b>Cet</b> imperméable coûte combien?    | How much is this raincoat?       |
| Je cherche <b>cette</b> robe bleue.      | I'm looking for this blue dress. |
| <b>Ces</b> chaussures sont trop petites. | These shoes are too small.       |

## Clothing Vocabulary

| French       | English                  | Gender | Example                    |
|--------------|--------------------------|--------|----------------------------|
| un pantalon  | trousers / pants         | m.     | <i>un pantalon noir</i>    |
| une chemise  | shirt (formal/button-up) | f.     | <i>une chemise blanche</i> |
| un tee-shirt | t-shirt                  | m.     | <i>un tee-shirt gris</i>   |
| un pull      | sweater / jumper         | m.     | <i>un pull bleu marine</i> |
| une veste    | jacket (non-formal)      | f.     | <i>une veste verte</i>     |

|                          |                     |        |                               |
|--------------------------|---------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| un manteau               | coat                | m.     | <i>un manteau gris</i>        |
| un imperméable           | raincoat            | m.     | <i>un imperméable beige</i>   |
| une robe                 | dress               | f.     | <i>une robe rouge</i>         |
| une jupe                 | skirt               | f.     | <i>une jupe noire</i>         |
| un jean                  | jeans               | m.     | <i>un jean bleu</i>           |
| des chaussures (f. pl.)  | shoes               | f. pl. | <i>des chaussures marron</i>  |
| des bottes (f. pl.)      | boots               | f. pl. | <i>des bottes noires</i>      |
| des baskets (f. pl.)     | trainers / sneakers | f. pl. | <i>des baskets blanches</i>   |
| une écharpe              | scarf               | f.     | <i>une écharpe rouge</i>      |
| un chapeau               | hat                 | m.     | <i>un chapeau beige</i>       |
| des chaussettes (f. pl.) | socks               | f. pl. | <i>des chaussettes grises</i> |
| un sac (à main)          | handbag             | m.     | <i>un sac noir</i>            |
| une ceinture             | belt                | f.     | <i>une ceinture marron</i>    |

## Colors and Adjective Agreement

Color adjectives in French agree with the noun in gender (m./f.) and number (sing./pl.). They usually come **after** the noun.

| Color  | Masculine sing. | Feminine sing. | Masculine pl. | Feminine pl. |
|--------|-----------------|----------------|---------------|--------------|
| black  | noir            | noire          | noirs         | noires       |
| white  | blanc           | blanche        | blancs        | blanches     |
| grey   | gris            | grise          | gris          | grises       |
| red    | rouge           | rouge          | rouges        | rouges       |
| blue   | bleu            | bleue          | bleus         | bleues       |
| green  | vert            | verte          | verts         | vertes       |
| yellow | jaune           | jaune          | jaunes        | jaunes       |
| purple | violet          | violette       | violets       | violettes    |

**Invariable colors (never change for gender or number):**

- *orange* — *un pull orange, une robe orange, des chaussures orange*
- *marron* (brown) — *un sac marron, des bottes marron*
- *rose* (pink) — *une veste rose, des baskets rose*
- *beige* — *un manteau beige*
- *bleu marine* (navy blue) — compound colors are invariable: *des pantalons bleu marine*

Common gender agreements in clothing context

| Item                    | Adjective | French                |
|-------------------------|-----------|-----------------------|
| le pantalon (m.)        | noir      | un pantalon noir      |
| la robe (f.)            | noire     | une robe noire        |
| les chaussures (f. pl.) | noires    | des chaussures noires |
| le pull (m.)            | vert      | un pull vert          |
| la veste (f.)           | verte     | une veste verte       |
| le tee-shirt (m.)       | gris      | un tee-shirt gris     |
| la chemise (f.)         | grise     | une chemise grise     |

Sizes

| French                               | English                                      |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| XS, S, M, L, XL, XXL                 | same as English                              |
| Quelle taille faites-vous?           | What size do you wear?                       |
| Je fais du 38 / du 40 / du 42.       | I'm a size 38/40/42. (French clothing sizes) |
| C'est trop grand.                    | It's too big.                                |
| C'est trop petit.                    | It's too small.                              |
| C'est la bonne taille.               | It's the right size.                         |
| Est-ce que vous avez ça en [taille]? | Do you have this in [size]?                  |

Shopping Phrases

| French                                 | English                             | Register |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| Je cherche...                          | I'm looking for...                  | Neutral  |
| Vous avez... en [couleur/taille]?      | Do you have... in [color/size]?     | Neutral  |
| Je peux l'essayer?                     | Can I try it on? (one item)         | Neutral  |
| Je peux les essayer?                   | Can I try them on? (two items/pair) | Neutral  |
| Où sont les cabines d'essayage?        | Where are the fitting rooms?        |          |
| Je vais le/la prendre.                 | I'll take it.                       |          |
| Je ne le/la prends pas, merci.         | I won't take it, thank you.         |          |
| Vous avez quelque chose de moins cher? | Do you have something cheaper?      |          |

|                                    |                 |  |
|------------------------------------|-----------------|--|
| C'est combien? / Ça coûte combien? | How much is it? |  |
|------------------------------------|-----------------|--|

## Prices and Numbers

Large numbers for prices:

| Number | French              |
|--------|---------------------|
| 100    | cent                |
| 101    | cent un             |
| 200    | deux cents          |
| 201    | deux cent un        |
| 250    | deux cent cinquante |
| 1 000  | mille               |

### Price format in French:

- €15 → *quinze euros*
- €15,50 → *quinze euros cinquante* (or *quinze euros et cinquante centimes* formally)
- €89 → *quatre-vingt-neuf euros*
- Prices use a comma as the decimal separator in France: €15,99

### Key price questions:

- *C'est combien?* — How much is it? (casual)
- *Ça coûte combien?* — How much does it cost?
- *Le prix est affiché?* — Is the price displayed?
- *Vous faites les soldes?* — Are you having a sale? (*les soldes* = the sales — January and July in France)

## Market Vocabulary

### Quantity Expressions

After quantity expressions, the article disappears — just *de* (or *d'* before vowel):

| French           | English                           | Example                       |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| un kilo de       | a kilo of                         | <i>un kilo de tomates</i>     |
| 500 grammes de   | 500 grams of                      | <i>500 grammes de fromage</i> |
| une livre de     | half a kilo (French pound = 500g) | <i>une livre de beurre</i>    |
| un litre de      | a liter of                        | <i>un litre de lait</i>       |
| une bouteille de | a bottle of                       | <i>une bouteille de vin</i>   |
| une douzaine de  | a dozen                           | <i>une douzaine d'œufs</i>    |

|                |              |                              |
|----------------|--------------|------------------------------|
| un paquet de   | a packet of  | <i>un paquet de farine</i>   |
| une tranche de | a slice of   | <i>une tranche de jambon</i> |
| un morceau de  | a piece of   | <i>un morceau de fromage</i> |
| un pot de      | a jar of     | <i>un pot de confiture</i>   |
| 100 grammes de | 100 grams of | <i>100 grammes de jambon</i> |

### Market and Food Products

| French                      | English     | Gender |
|-----------------------------|-------------|--------|
| une tomate                  | tomato      | f.     |
| une pomme                   | apple       | f.     |
| une orange                  | orange      | f.     |
| une banane                  | banana      | f.     |
| une fraise                  | strawberry  | f.     |
| un citron                   | lemon       | m.     |
| des raisins (m. pl.)        | grapes      | m. pl. |
| une pomme de terre          | potato      | f.     |
| une carotte                 | carrot      | f.     |
| des haricots verts (m. pl.) | green beans | m. pl. |
| un œuf / des œufs           | egg / eggs  | m.     |
| du beurre                   | butter      | m.     |
| du lait                     | milk        | m.     |
| de la farine                | flour       | f.     |
| du miel                     | honey       | m.     |
| de la confiture             | jam         | f.     |
| du fromage                  | cheese      | m.     |
| du jambon                   | ham         | m.     |
| du pain                     | bread       | m.     |

### Market Phrases

| French         | English         |
|----------------|-----------------|
| Je voudrais... | I would like... |

|                                      |                                |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Donnez-moi...                        | Give me... (at a market stall) |
| Un kilo de tomates, s'il vous plaît. | A kilo of tomatoes, please.    |
| C'est combien le kilo?               | How much per kilo?             |
| Et avec ça?                          | Anything else?                 |
| C'est tout, merci.                   | That's all, thank you.         |
| Vous avez du fromage de chèvre?      | Do you have goat's cheese?     |

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## Pronunciation Notes

- **Ce / cet / cette / ces:** *ce* = /sə/, *cet* = /sɛt/, *cette* = /sɛt/ (cet and cette sound identical), *ces* = /sɛ/
  - **Chemise:** /ʃəmiz/ — the *ch* sounds like English "sh," not like "ch" in "church"
  - **Imperméable:** /ɛ̃pʁɛmɛabl/ — five syllables; the final -e is silent; stress on the second-to-last syllable
  - **Douzaine:** /duzɛn/ — two syllables, rhymes with "main" in English
  - **Trop grand:** the *p* at the end of *trop* is silent when followed by a consonant
  - **Quatre-vingt-neuf:** /katʁəvɛ̃ŋtœf/ — literally "four-twenty-nine" (80+9); the -f in *neuf* is sounded when *neuf* stands alone or before a consonant, but silent before *heures* in time
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